



INDIAN ORGANISATIONS FIGHTING COVID-19

HOW COMPANIES AND ORGANISATIONS ARE TAKING THE FIGHT TO COVID-19 IN INDIA

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In the previous story you saw how Indian startups are helping combat COVID-19 across India. Fortunately, they're not the only ones in this fight. Several more prominent tech companies and educational organisations in the nation, and even outside of the nation, are pitching in to help with the fight against the novel coronavirus. Let's take a look at some of their technologies and innovations.

IIT DELHI

IIT Delhi developed a COVID-19 testing kit that has been validated at the ICMR with a sensitivity and specificity of a 100 percent. They started working on the kit in January with the goal of creating an affordable, low-cost diagnostic tool. This kit is basically a swab testing kit, and is much cheaper than existing testing kits, making it ideal for a population as large as ours. This test kit was developed by researchers at IIT-Delhi's Kusuma School of Biological Sciences



IIT Delhi's swab testing kit for COVID-19

(KSBS). Not only is this test less invasive, it's also affordable and convenient for high throughput testing.

IIT KANPUR

The spread of the novel coronavirus has led to a huge demand of Personal Protective Equipment (PPEs), especially for those working in essential services who are at risk of exposure. Standard PPE kits are pretty low

on supply. To that end, a team of researchers at IIT Kanpur in partnership with industry partners have designed a PIPES kit which uses cylindrical rolls of polyethylene, a non-porous substance commonly used in the packaging industry. The design and creation process for the PIPES kit is completely open-source, anyone can pick them up and start manufacturing them in large quantities within a few days. While they're not as comfortable as traditional PPE kits, they will get the job done and aren't difficult to work in for hours on end according to testers at IIT Kanpur. Additionally, they're very cheap, allowing for mass production for as little as ₹100.

ZOHO

Zoho Corp is an Indian software development company that focuses on web-based business tools and IT management software. We got in touch with Zoho and learned about the efforts